7

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Why the BJP Wins on Social Media[1]

When Modi Hung Out with Ajay Devgn on Google+

Before Akshay Kumar, there was Ajay Devgn. Soon after Google+ launched in India, Narendra Modi, then chief minister of Gujarat, appeared on the new digital platform to participate in a live and interactive Google+ Hangout session, moderated by the actor Ajay Devgn. It was 31 August 2012. Modi was heading into his third state assembly election contest and Google was aggressively promoting the Hangouts feature. The broadcast proved to be a happy meeting ground for both politician and platform. The video chat had to be delayed, starting an hour later than 8 p.m. as scheduled, because Google+ 'systems crashed' with 'so much of traffic in lakhs' that it took 'us an hour to manage that', an apologetic Devgn told viewers who had logged in. 'I have been watching thirty–forty friends from Google here for the past hour who been have working hard to figure out how to clear the traffic,' began Modi. 'Traffic policemen on the road don't get as much trouble as the trouble my friends here were facing,' he quipped as he too apologised for the delay, before going on to thank Google and say that the platform was 'catching the pulse of the globe'.[2]

The chat itself had been advertised for four days prior to 31 August on the chief minister's personal website,